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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Wednesday, March 8, 2023

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[00:13:02] Good morning. Welcome to the standing committee for lab schools meeting. It's Wednesday, March 8th, and we are here in Richmond. We're going to begin the meeting with a moment of silence, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance, and then we'll move into electing leadership for this committee and then move into our formal meeting. So let's start with a moment of silence.

[00:13:24] Pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, liberty and justice for all.

[00:14:00] Okay. Our first order of business is to elect our committee leadership. And if it pleases my colleagues, I would like to entertain a motion that Joan Wodiska, chair of the standing committee. Is there a second? Any discussion?

[00:14:18] I think there's been a few. We've had a chance to talk about this and think about it. I think there's a lot of support, Jen, the terrific work you've done for the state previously, and then in helping us here with this, which is a really important priority for the Commonwealth. And so I think it's a fantastic choice. All right. All in favor, signify by saying aye. Opposed? All right. And then would you like me to do the motion for a vice chair, even though it's now you're a committee? Okay. Thank you. All right. Well, good afternoon again. It is my honor to

[00:14:57] nominate Dr. Pam Moran to serve as the vice chair of the committee. Is there a second? Second. Is there any discussion? I will just say, I think it's fantastic. First of all, that Pam's on the committee and second has been a leader on this issue when she was a superintendent and Albemarle was very forward looking on this issue of how do we provide more options for families, more customization for kids, different paths for kids while they're in high school. It really was a leader in the Commonwealth on that. And so I just think it's fantastic that we're going to have her not only on the committee, but in a leadership role on the standing committee. I too am incredibly

[00:15:34] excited about Dr. Moran stepping into this role. She, as we all know from having been the superintendent, has really been a leader in the Commonwealth for a variety of learning options for students. She has an amazing resume that I feel like merits just a quick mention. She was one of four finalists for the AASA National Superintendent of the Year. She has also been recognized as a National Tech Savvy Superintendent, was the BAM Education Superintendent of the Year, and of course the Virginia Superintendent of the Year. She was also a gubernatorial appointee to the State Higher

[00:16:09] Education Council for Virginia, for which her expertise and service on that body will be of great benefit to this work. And she is also the past president of the Virginia Association of school superintendents and Dr. Moran thank you so much for being willing to serve in this capacity all right all those in favor of the motion any opposed

[00:16:37] motion carries Dr. Moran thank you Dr. Moran and I both had the occasion Dr. Moran was the president of Virginia school superintendents at the same time that I was the president of the Virginia School Boards Association. So we go way back and had a wonderful opportunity to collaborate between those two entities. So with that, we're going to move through to our agenda item of approval of the minutes from December 22nd and February 2023.

[00:17:16] Actually, we haven't adopted the agenda yet. Excuse me. Actually, first, let's see if there's motion to approve the agenda as presented is there a second um mr chapman i'm going to have you call the role on the motion to adopt the agenda as presented also to again establish quorum thank you members of the standing committee hi mr rotherham hi ms moran dr moran bailey and uh

[00:17:50] mr hanson let the record note mr hanson is absent today you guys have it and the agenda is officially adopted and with that we will now move to approval of the minutes for the december as i noted 2022 and february 2023 meeting the staff transmitted the draft of the minutes from the december and february meeting to you on march 2nd are there any corrections to the meeting minutes as distributed all right i'm hearing no further corrections the minutes stand approved as distributed

[00:18:24] we'll now move to the next agenda item which is a public comment for this meeting for agenda items It is the habit of the Board of Education to accept public comment at each of its scheduled public business meetings. This is the habit that the Lab Committee will be adopting and following as input from the public at each stage of our work is an important step to guarantee transparency and quality of the work that is done on behalf of this body.

[00:18:50] Whereas the State Board accepts public comment on all matters related to public education in Virginia, this standing committee will humbly follow suit in the scope assigned to it by the board and accept public comment on matters related to college partnership schools in Virginia. And as chair, I would like to adopt a policy of accepting public comment on agenda items as those items are called before this body, and that the standing committee will accept public comment on items unrelated to the agenda at the

conclusion of our meeting to ensure orderly business is attended to in a timely manner. Commenters will be recognized

[00:19:29] in the order in which they are requested and received and commenters will include their name again all consistent with the order and operation of the state board of education so at this time we do not have any public comment on the agenda items but i just did want to review that for the sake of the benefit of the public so with that we're going to move on to item b which is review and approval of the standing committee schedule for 2023. now um in the future the staff or ms Valinsky who assisted with the production of this document will present items. Today in her absence

[00:20:04] I will be setting up a number of the committee agenda items for your discussion and our discussion but again in the future the staff will take on this role. In your packet is proposed meeting schedule. This is again item B. The standing committee schedule plan sets out the submission of materials to the committee, the lab committee date of the meeting, the first review and application, the day to consider an application and the days for public comment the days to prepare a written report to the board and the number of days to be added to the state board agenda working backwards

[00:20:41] from the state board schedule the proposed standing committee schedule creates a planned schedule from today to the end of the year the standing committee replicates procedural precedents set by the state board such as affording 10 days for public comment or the adoption of their deadline to submit materials to the state board for their consideration in general the committee would meet three weeks before the state board of education on a monday except in the case of a nearby holiday

[00:21:16] the committee would need on a wednesday the committee will meet in april may june july september october and november aligned to the state board's schedule um with that item now teed up i'd ask if there are any comments discussions or edits to the calendar as presented hearing none the calendar is approved as distributed with i would ask the allowance for staff to run

[00:21:52] one more spell check and adjust any formatting that might be necessary prior to further distribution all right now we'll turn to item c which is first review of the college partnership committee application process including in your packet is a document that visualizes the process the purpose of the committee application process is twofold first this document is intended to visualize and delineate the roles and responsibilities of the

[00:22:27] applicant the virginia department of education the lab committee and the state board of education second the purpose of this document is to transparently document the internal process that we will collectively go through to review lab school applications this is to be a benefit to both the applicant as well as all parties that are interested in the work of this committee and lab schools across the commonwealth in terms of the process the process to review a lab school

[00:23:01] application follows the virginia college lab school application process and guidelines as approved by the state board of education on august 31st 2022 and further amended on february 3rd 2023 vdoe continues to review this item to ensure continuity with state board guidance it is worth noting that the lab committee process is consistent with the prior process created by the State Board of Education for lab committee consideration. To this end, number one, the process is intended to

[00:23:39] be fair, transparent, consistent, and predictable. And number two, it is to provide ample opportunity for public input and public feedback. As you can see from the process document, VDOE can

offer interested applicants technical assistance to ensure that applicant applications are complete and compliant with federal and state laws. This process would envision that VDOE would provide technical support, ideally through the planning grant process, prior to the submittal of an

[00:24:14] application before this committee. But through this process before the standing committee, again, VDOE may also provide support and assistance to applicants. In addition, the lab standing committee is proposed that there would be additional feedback loops to support and foster innovation and learning and to further support a shared responsibility and a shared success model. To this end, I would highlight the following elements. While VDOE must review

[00:24:47] applications for completeness and compliance, an essential part of our process is to emphasize that VDOE would also provide technical assistance, coaching, and if needed, intensive technical support from internal as well as external subject matter experts. A VDOE currently provides technical assistance, and it is recognized that this will continue. The chart proposes and would recommend to the State Board of Education that further support would be offered to applicants to

[00:25:25] enable a culture of innovation and idea sharing. We've heard from committee members and the public that it is important that the lab committee process include the long-standing subject matter expertise of the VDOE and other subject matter experts to afford interested applicants and their community, most of all students, a pathway forward to success.

[00:25:49] In addition through this document, the committee would recommend to the State Board the creation of two PLCs, two professional learning communities. The first learning community would be for planning grant winners to coordinate, collaborate, and learn from and support one another, and certainly this is a key to VDOE providing meaningful support to the planning grant winners. The second PLC would be for the Virginia lab schools once approved. If an applicant, the lab school would become a member of the Virginia

[00:26:26] lab school public PLC again so that they could learn, share, study, and communicate with their peers. Equally important to this process, however, is that this would create a formal vehicle to share those learnings with any school division or higher education institution in Virginia, or even, I'd imagine, other states. As a grant recipient, with that support comes an obligation to learn and support and share those findings with others, and this process envisions that shared responsibility. Again, this is very similar to the work done already by the Virginia

[00:27:04] Department of Education and consistent with state board practice, but in this document, these processes are transparently shown and would be formalized. In summary, the three lab committee processes that would follow, these guidelines would follow the guidelines as amended and acted upon by the State Board of Education with three additional recommendations to the State Board. One would be for the creation of a planning grant PLC. The second would be to support intensive external and internal ta for applicants and three would be the creation of a va

[00:27:44] lab school plc lastly and i'm almost done procedurally the proposed committee process would clarify and recommend to the state board of education an expedited consideration process for applicants that have been approved by this committee to be eligible for approval upon first review by the state board of education in this regard the process envisions that this committee would provide a thorough review of the applications deliberate with numerous opportunities

[00:28:21] for public comment and public input and thereby allow the board should the board elect to expedite board consideration let me offer one last thought having had an opportunity to chat with my colleagues. Education is a team sport, and our team is Virginia. And the lab committee and our process must first and foremost act as a neutral and impartial judge to fairly review applications and make recommendations to the state board. And the state board is relying upon this committee

[00:28:55] and our members to dispatch our duties with fairness, consistency, and thoroughness. And for that I appreciate the opportunity to serve. So with that item now presented at this time, I would open it up for comments from members of the committee. Mr. Bailey. Love the process. What I particularly appreciate is the amount of coaching. It's just not trying to weed out applicants but help set them up for success and give them lots of feedback. I have past experiences with different

[00:29:29] types of grants and processes like this. I think that that will bring a lot of benefit to whether they get approved or just help keep advancing their ideas and refining it. So I just appreciate the amount of effort that went into this to help set applicants up for success.

[00:29:47] Comments from others? Dr. Moran? I would just note that being able to look at this in such a concisely laid out way would be so helpful to applicants to be able to gauge where they are in the process and what support they may need and i think that in building perhaps a guide behind this it will help people know where do i go when do i go what might i get from the process that will support up being sure that people are on target and that there are no surprises when they get to the committee level in terms of whether

[00:30:24] they are both complete and compliant in their application so i think it's a great setup for success versus failure. Thank you, Dr. Moran. Mr. Rotherham? I don't have much to add. I agree with both my colleagues. Just I think what's exciting about this is we're, as Joan said, like education is a team sport, but like in states that have been really successful with increasing options like this, it doesn't happen in isolation. It happens with an environment of collaboration and support. And so I think it is like not only are we sort of moving forward with the lab school initiative, but starting to put in place what that ecosystem of support is going to start to look

[00:31:01] like, I think in terms of the long-term interest in the Commonwealth is really exciting. Thank you. No further comment at this time, we're going to move to item D, which is discussion on updates on the application, the lab school FAQs, and the website. During the process to review the evaluation rubric, which is actually going to be item E, VDOE staff were asked to also review the evaluation rubric, the website, the application, and the FAQs to not only ensure that these items included

[00:31:39] the 31 required elements, but also applicable state and federal laws. Given the thorough review that is currently undergoing, as well as the recent Board of Education revised guidance that was adopted on February 2, 2023, we would anticipate that additional changes will be necessary to one, the lab school application, two, the FAQs, and three, other documents related to the lab schools. In particular, we would anticipate that the FAQs will likely be an evolving document

[00:32:12] to answer as it is aptly named frequently asked questions. More to come, but we do expect that these documents will work in concert with one another and that there will be items for your review at the upcoming meeting i'd like to ask mr chapman to provide a brief update as to the internal review that's currently going on at vdoe to update these items on our behalf yes thank you very much um my name is jim chapman i'm the interim director of board relations for the

[00:32:47] department of education um as you know you know this is a lab schools is an area that's going to touch on so many different aspects of the of the department's work and so we do find the need for a considerable amount of expertise and review within the department in order to make sure that all of these items are as uh miss wadiska said fitting together in the right way um so we are convening you know internal uh groups uh including dr brendan albin who's sitting next to me who is the currently the director of stem and innovation at the department has been working very closely on the lab schools initiative within the department um as well as others you know in order to be sure

[00:33:25] that that we are are seeing this in a comprehensive way so as those uh as those work groups convene not only to help review of the applications and make sure that the what you saw in the flow chart um that the department is is reviewing these applications uh providing feedback and commentary working with the applicant applicants and ultimately providing the standing committee with a working document to begin your own review of this application that same group will be involved in helping us uh do perform all of these items as well and making sure this review is taking place we do expect and we hope to have uh updates and more information on on what we think uh

[00:34:00] recommendation for passport at the april board or the april committee meeting sorry thank you mr chapman any comments from committee members on item d this one really is more an informational item for your just awareness and the public's awareness that these uh all these documents are being looked at in concert with one another for consistency and thoroughness yeah no the only question comment i have is just on the faqs just to encourage people to send faq there's still you know as you go around and talk to people about this still just confusion misunderstandings about how it works what these schools will do not do all of that i think it's a it's a valuable

[00:34:40] public document to help hopefully clarify some of those confusions and misconceptions and help people get questions that they have about those things answered in a sort of forthright and accessible way so that's actually given just how new this is is actually one of the most important things that we're going to be doing is being able to sort of share that information out any other comments just that as we continue to move through the process setups for this and the procedural setups there's nothing that's more important to people in the field than clarity and that this

[00:35:15] will bring a much higher level of clarity so that people know what am i getting into as i get this process started and what are the advantages and benefits and opportunities that will be afforded to young people as a result of going through this process i anticipate that even if people went through the process and did not take their application forward they will learn so much from going through this that it will absolutely have impact in positive ways in any uh division and the Higher Education Institute.

[00:35:45] Thank you, everyone, for your, thank you, Mr. Chapman, again, for your update. At this time, we're going to move to item E, which is first review of the College Partnership Laboratory School Evaluation Rubric. The evaluation rubric, as I will shorthand it, is intended to create a transparent and objective evaluative rubric to consider lab school applications based on the lab school requirements.

[00:36:17] VDOE legal and subject matter experts are currently reviewing item e again for completeness and correctness. The evaluation rubric will be used to evaluate the lab school applications and it's worth noting that the rubric will also be updated to include applicable non-negotiable non-waivable state and federal laws such as compliance with IDEA, FERPA, or the applicable SOQs.

[00:36:46] VDOE will be denoting, they've been asked to denote those elements that are optional or those elements where a waiver may be requested or those elements that are in fact non-waiverable. As noted in the FAQs, lab schools are subject to all federal and state laws and regulations prohibiting discrimination or serve and ensuring that students with disabilities are served. Enrollment shall be open to any child who is deemed to reside within the Commonwealth through a lottery process on a space available basis. These

[00:37:21] elements will be clarified through the document. Committee members, if you have any feedback on this particular item, please submit that to staff through SharePoint to Mr. Chapman and the team, staff have been asked and directed that rather than be quick, it is critical that this task, this evaluation tool be done well. And so a complete update is expected to be presented to you for your consideration in April. And I really want to say a big thank you to the entire internal team at VDOE for prioritizing this task. It is a big

[00:37:59] task. It is a difficult task, but I'm very pleased that it's being done well and in concert to ensure that that application and the evaluation rubric will be fair and thorough for anyone going through the process, just as Dr. Moran and Mr. Rotherham have indicated the importance that that will be.

[00:38:18] So at this time, I would entertain. Are there any comments or edits from committee members on item E? okay thank you and and mr chapman we should anticipate a spit spot version of this document come the april meeting is that correct absolutely all right thank you all right with that we are now going to move to item f item f is first review of the college partnership laboratory school template

[00:38:53] for the state board of education report this committee is tasked to prepare a report and recommendation to the State Board of Education. The draft in item F follows the format most recently utilized by the previous lab committee to submit a report to the State Board of Education.

[00:39:15] This update, this report will be updated to reflect the current requirements for lab schools to operate within the Commonwealth of Virginia. Again, no action is expected to be taken today at this time rather item f is included and presented for your awareness edits changes as well as public input and awareness and again if there are any edits specific edits that you would like made to this document please submit them to mr chapman by utilization of sharepoint but at this time i would entertain if there are any questions on this document or any comments from committee members

[00:39:53] all right hearing none we'll continue on item g presentations and written report at the last meeting mr hansen raised a really excellent question that we thought would be beneficial for the committee to have an answer to um we in an effort to anticipate what will be the workload of this committee it's important to have a sight line into the lab school planning grant winners who has applied, how many have applied, and what is the status of their interest. If you look at

[00:40:29] item G, this gives us a first glimpse, as I like to say, into the future. You can see through this interactive map that lab school planning grants have been approved across the commonwealth. There are, at this time, 13 approved college partnership lab planning grant recipients, and there are five planning grants currently under review. The document included in the agenda briefly outlines what the proposed and approved planning grant winners or recipients, excuse me,

[00:41:09] are proposing to do with their plans, their area of focus, as well as their local partners. Any questions for staff on item G or would staff like to further discuss this item before the the committee. Dr. Alban, would you be interested in giving a little bit of an overview about the development of the

interactive map in particular? I know that's something that you've been working on, correct? Certainly. Thank you so much. The planning grant application process has been very interesting because I applaud those institutes of higher education who've gone that

[00:41:46] route because we have been able to provide a lot of technical assistance to these applicants to be able to be in touch with them and say, I can see what you're trying here, but this may need some tweaking. That may not meet the definition of a college partnership lab school application when the time does come. It allows them to refine and it allows them to come up with something that when they do submit their full application will hopefully be a lot closer to an ideal application when the time does come. We've had opportunity to speak with several. We've had some applications

[00:42:25] where we've asked them to make some changes and adjustments. There have been resubmissions and those have been approved as plan and grant applicants. Now, plan and grant applicant does not necessarily mean that that application is ready to box and go for a lab school. It means that you're on the right road, you're in the correct planning phase, there will be some moves along the way that we will need to make, and we're still open to those adjustments through technical assistance. And many of those applicants have already made those changes.

[00:43:02] We've seen some interesting things. We're very pleased with the variety of plan and grant applications that have come in. There have been some that have been focused on the original layout of how a planning grant was that it would work with a teacher preparation program where it would be about developing teachers now there's much broader scope where we've got several different kinds of planning grants that are coming in there are those there are some that are focused quite strongly in terms of particularly for the applications that are looking toward the

[00:43:40] high school area of having students be career ready or college ready having schools that are going to be able to expedite and be able to support more students for the next step in life and then the third type that we've have seen are some applications that are looking to actually go into a school division and support a school through either teacher prep students or actually particular instructional focus in an existing school or even to revive a school that was previously closed. So we've got a very broad range of applications that we have seen.

[00:44:21] We have averaged about one application per week since we started, so we've had to turn these around rather quickly. The process that we have is that there are a group of people who do review these against a rubric that is used, that is evidence in the application itself. Feedback has been given to all applications. There is no perfect application that has been submitted.

[00:44:46] Some applicants, as I said, have been asked to make adjustments, but you're good to go. Some applications have been asked, make adjustments, and then we can reconsider, and we have. If you take a look at that map, what we have done is to be able to, and this is really the first step of something that is going to become more evident with time because the whole college partnership lab school process in a sense it's not exactly building the airplane while it's in flight because there was some move toward this previously it is our hope that we are putting

[00:45:21] more effort more refinement to actually being able to get some great lab schools up and running but as we are going through as you mentioned the faqs we're discovering things that might help us to support the applicants a lot better so this map was an example of a response to if i am at an institute of higher ed or even a school division and we're interested in putting out a planning grant and ultimately a

lab school application we'd like to know well what's in the water what is good what is going on what what maybe isn't working well and being able to see hey who's trying what who's doing that i've got this idea you know what there's a lab school application

[00:46:00] in region five and we're in region two but they want to do just what we want to do so maybe being able to go there and have a level of public showing of what these lab school applications are it allows potential applicants to say well let me reach out to that person there's their name there's their phone number what are you doing maybe we can learn from you what feedback are you getting just so that the process is as open as is possible and putting that out there also assures the public that the taxpayer money that is being invested in these lab schools is really

[00:46:35] going to go a long way it is moving forward there are lab schools that that are being developed there are institutes of higher ed who are putting together some really interesting and cool stuff and ultimately the goal at the end is for us to have some lab schools who are going to try to do some things that will inform practice at all schools. We do not want these to be a frozen, chosen group of schools out there. It's our hope that we are able to support things that if a lab school application was completely way out there, that's nice, that's great,

[00:47:10] but we want to see can you do something where you are able to show things and try things that may someday be replicable throughout classrooms in Virginia. So that's really a big thing that we do look for. A really, really good piece of feedback that I've taken note of is we need to be explicit with these applicants that even though there is a lab school, there is compliance to the Code of Virginia, to the Standards of Quality, Standards of Accreditation. And that is, you know, that's an example of some modification that we are moving towards. Looking down the road, I do know that we

[00:47:44] are looking to also develop more guidance to potential applicants of what does a good application look like what would be something that we are looking for just so they can kind of see what's going on through the process before they even submit an application i will add that you know the standing committee is aptly named because the process of standing up a school is an unbelievable task, you know, and certainly, you know, to commend not only Dr. Albin and his team, but Assistant State Superintendent Elizabeth Schultz, who's put a remarkable amount of effort

[00:48:21] into, you know, this front side. I think we are aware of the importance that this will have in terms of generating exactly the type of lab school applications that the Standing Committee is going to want to see. But to highlight one of the most interesting things that Dr. Albin touched on, commend to the Standing Committee really using this interactive map and hopefully soaking in the sheer variety of proposals that are out there, the sheer variety of K-12 partners, the geographic representation that's evident in the interest right now, the higher education

[00:49:00] partners stemming from community colleges to some of the flagship institutions in the state, the diversity of nonprofit partners, everyone from the Cal Ripken Foundation, one of my childhood heroes, and industry partners, everything from maritime to aerospace. I mean, this is unbelievable, the amount of interest and the sight that lab schools are becoming for all of these different entities being involved in the exact same space. And so what an amazing opportunity. And we are grateful that this resource will hopefully help you see that that interest that's being sparked.

[00:49:38] Dr. Albin, Dr. Mr. Chapin, that's incredibly exciting. Thank you for your diligence and your support for interested applicants. It really is important. Would you please describe, really for the benefit of

the public, again, the planning grant opportunity. You know, it is so rare, i think in education that when there is a new opportunity presented to a higher education institution or school division for that matter those entities typically have to go through the

[00:50:11] process invest their staff in time their own resources to submit an application and the really rare opportunity that the commonwealth is presenting here is support to move through that planning process. And I wondered if you might further describe that again.

[00:50:29] Certainly. So the opportunity to apply for a planning grant allows an applicant to apply for some funds. And what those funds will do is it will buy the applicant a little bit of time to even onboard some personnel to take ownership and responsibility for guiding the creation of the school, at least to the point of startup. There are funds set aside in the legislative

[00:51:00] allotment from the fund for that. This is an interesting kind of initiative because really what we're doing is we're creating a brand new kind of school. A long time ago when Governor Halton started up governor's schools in Virginia, that was a whole new creation. That's different from the local school down the road. It was, here's a whole new thing. What is it? How does it work? And it's, you know, clearly I'm not from around here, but a lot of folks who've always lived here and have always been familiar with Virginia public schooling, you know,

[00:51:39] your kid gets to go to the local school. Here are the offerings for the most part. You know what to expect. There are these opportunities. And then if you don't necessarily want to buy into that then you could do private you could do home schooling there are those options but he has a completely brand new thing and with that comes a little bit of i won't say ignorance but there's a lack of knowledge it's it's that lack of institutional knowledge of i know what my typical high school is like but no one really knows what a typical lab school is like and first of all there should never be such a thing as a typical lab school however it is a space that is

[00:52:18] afforded to institutes of higher ed to be able to try something new as well as step over the line and come up with crazy ideas number one we encourage it but number two sometimes we do have to say you're going to need to do this you're going to need to that it does buy the applicants up to a year of being able to try different things do different ideas and somehow create an entirely new ecosystem of learning. Thank you, Dr. Alban. That was incredibly helpful.

[00:52:53] Any other comments from members of the committee? All right. Yeah, I just want to quickly just say like the work, I mean, this has been a busy time these past couple months. You know, there's a lot of things moving along. The assembly was obviously here and that was busy. And we've had some transition here at the department recently.

[00:53:11] And you all just done a fantastic job and some other team members who aren't in the room. And I And I just wanted to make sure to call that out in getting this stuff prepared. There's a lot of detail there. You know, as you said just a moment ago, we're bringing something into being that hasn't really been in being.

[00:53:27] And so that takes a lot of work. And just to commend you all for where we are. It's exciting. Thank you. And thank you for being here this morning to speak with us. That moves us to item H, administrative update. Mr. Chapman? Yes.

[00:53:43] Sorry. Yes. Thank you very much, Ms. Wodiska. The two big items to discuss are both state emails, you know, and the SharePoint site that you all are using. Those two things dovetail very nicely, and I believe we only have currently one state email, at least on the Standing Committee, left to set up, and there's plans for that this afternoon.

[00:54:05] And so that's fantastic. You may be aware, I mean, a lot of you have been in state government for quite some time, been involved in this type of thing, and there's a lot of benefits to having this state email account. To touch on one of the big issues, you know, there's certainly the logistical things, the convenience that this will add for you all to have a dedicated email, but also the opportunities for collaboration sharing with staff that that's going to open up, facilitating using the Microsoft platform that the state is now on, will allow us to share documents, work collaboratively with you individually on edits and things that you propose for not only work for the standing committee, but other items that you might see fit.

[00:54:44] um the other really nice benefit is that uh is that as um requests under the freedom of information act have become a lot more common in this day and age uh having those state email accounts and if you're using that for your state business uh for business of this committee makes it a lot easier to to comply to make sure that um that you know state law is being followed um the sharepoint site as you're all aware uh has has a couple of hiccups still we're still still rolling out this technology it's it's easy um to you know at least forget from our side this is about a month fresh uh you know to the state of having these new tools and so we'll be working

[00:55:20] with you to make sure you have all of the access that you need um that you're able to to see items the way you want and that again if you're if you're looking to make comments and share those with staff that we work on good processes uh to facilitate the work that you're doing because there's going to be a lot of it especially over over the coming months we do expect that there will be um a great opportunity to utilize all of these tools that are now at your disposal mr chapman merits our gratitude for deploying his agency to ensure that we have all the modern day technological

[00:55:54] support to dispatch our duties with ease and efficiency as well as public transparency so thank you mr chapman for your resistance it has been a wonderful improvement in our procedure process. I think we should call Mr. Chapman Iron Man. Agreed, agreed. Mr. Bailey's favorite baseball player is Jose Canseco, so it's a little more awkward, so I think we'll go with Iron Man.

[00:56:24] Mostly for Iron Man in a second. Hearing no objection, I think that was adopted by consent. My new favorite statement. oh that brings us to discussion of current issues um this is a place that we will hold on our agenda for announcements or updates to be made by members of the committee i want to acknowledge in particular that mr bailey mr hansen dr moran mr rothraham are all experts in their field and bring a tremendous amount to the work before this committee and i would invite them at any time to

[00:57:03] provide policy updates insights information that they believe may be a benefit to applicants the lab school community as we are creating it or staff so this will be kind of a parking lot area the second item is i've already heard from from staff in the future we may want to envision having a potential standing item on the agenda for legislative recommendations to the State Board of Education. Already through our deliberations have surfaced that there may be some areas where

[00:57:42] lab school applicants may need further flexibility, things that would be of benefit to our learning community here in the Commonwealth. And I would like to ensure that our process here has a

way to again have that kind of continuous feedback loop of as we learn something as a lab committee that we're able to act upon that and share that knowledge with the state board with mr rotherham and his colleagues and so that might be something that we'll kind of put into this element as well but let me pause there and see if there are comments from the committee members that they

[00:58:16] would like to share okay all right that moves us to uh our two remaining items that does public comment on non-agenda items and mr chapman would you assist me with this item i understand that we may have two uh we may have some public commenters we may we did have two individuals sign up um and we can call them in order uh wilma brown foreman you're not famous for him and uh cammy sanghara

[00:58:51] thank you mr chapman um i know that you'll follow up with the commenters and invite them to submit written comments to the lab committee for our consideration and those written comments can be submitted through the web form that is available on the standing committee's web page which is on videoe's website and all these comments that are received will be kept as part of the public record on behalf of this committee can we just pause on that for a moment madam uh chairman it this is a big commonwealth and it's a long way to come to richmond and that

[00:59:28] issue of people being able to submit in writing like we should just make sure we underscore that both here for people who are watching and in our communications because like people sometimes come a long way and it's a limited uh public comment period in terms of the minutes and you can submit more by writing you don't have to come with the comedians meeting here north virginia or elsewhere to physically be present and we do see that we get it all with the staff does great work making sure it's all organized for us and it gets read and it really is a great way to participate in the process with a little less wear and tear on yourself also add that the lab school committee

[01:00:04] has a very specific focus and that anyone can bring anything to us but that it may or may not fit within the scope of what we're charged to do and if someone does that they need to know that we will make sure that that feedback ends up going to the appropriate place inside the department or at the state board level for consideration as well i may miss wadiska um we will also uh point out that the both the board and the standing committee have recently moved to a much more i think technologically useful way of receiving that public comment through our microsoft forms and so absolutely

[01:00:44] you know to dr moran's point that will make it much easier for a comment that is directed not towards lab schools but more broadly towards public education that we can immediately move that over and make sure that the state board receives that before their meeting and make sure that the committee has that information as well and miss wadiska if i might um might offer were you going to move to seeing if there was additional public comment from anyone else present thank you i was yeah you read my mind it's a good team we have all right hearing no desire for additional further comment. At this juncture, I'll remind the committee members and the public that our

[01:01:23] next meeting will be Wednesday, April 12th at 10 a.m. here in Richmond. And if there's no further business, this meeting is adjourned. Thank you for your time.



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